

HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY AND PROCEDURE

Anti-discrimination Policy:

Policy brief & purpose

Our anti-discrimination policy explains how we prevent discrimination and protect our employees, customers and stakeholders from offensive and harmful behaviours. This policy supports our overall commitment to create a safe and happy workplace for everyone.

Our company complies with all anti-discrimination laws, including explicitly prohibiting offensive behaviour (e.g. derogatory comments towards colleagues of a specific gender or ethnicity.)

Policy Elements

This is not an exhaustive list, but here are some instances that we consider discrimination:

- Hiring managers disproportionately disqualify male or female job candidates on purpose. Managers bypass team members with specific protected characteristics (e.g., race) for promotion without being able to formally prove (e.g., with documentation) the reasons other employees were selected instead.
- Employees making sexist comments.
- Employees sending emails disparage someone's ethnic origin.
- Employees who harass their colleagues will go through our disciplinary process, and we may reprimand, demote, or terminate them depending on the severity of their offence.



We recognize that sometimes discrimination is unintentional, as we may all have unconscious biases that could be difficult to identify and overcome. In the event that we conclude that an employee unconsciously discriminates, we will support them through training and counselling and implement processes that mitigate biases, as we will indicate in the next section. But if this person shows unwillingness to change their behaviour, we may demote or terminate them.

We will not be lenient in cases of assault, sexual harassment, or workplace violence, whether physical or psychological. We will terminate employees who behave like this immediately.

☐ **Actions to prevent discrimination**

To ensure that our conduct and processes are fair and lawful, we:

- Use inclusive language in job ads and include EEO statements.
- Set formal job-related criteria to hire, promote, and reward team members.
- Offer compensation and benefits according to position, seniority, qualifications, and performance, not protected characteristics.
- Accommodate people with disabilities.
- Require managers to keep detailed records of their decisions concerning their team members and job candidates.

☐ **What to do in cases of discrimination**

If you are the victim of discriminatory behaviour (or if you suspect that others are being discriminated against), please talk to HR (or your manager) as soon as possible. HR is responsible for hearing your claim, investigating the issue, and determining punishment.

Punishment for discriminatory behaviour depends on the severity of the offence. For example, inadvertently offending someone might warrant a reprimand. Conversely, wilfully bypassing employees for promotion because of a protected characteristic will result in termination.

If you decide to make a claim to a regulatory body (e.g., the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission), we are committed and bound by law not to retaliate against you.



☐ How we address discrimination complaints

HR is proactive and responsive about determining whether discrimination occurs. For example, we:

- Look into similar claims about the same person or process to determine if discrimination is systemic.
- Track metrics and look into data that gives us some insight on people's behaviours (e.g. Percentage of job applicants of a certain race a hiring manager disqualifies.)
- We will investigate all claims discreetly. We will never disclose who made a complaint to anyone or give out information that may help others identify that person (e.g. which department or role they work in.)

We should all strive to prevent and address discrimination. Be aware of your implicit biases and speak up whenever you or your colleagues are discriminated against. If you have any ideas on how we can ensure fairness and equality in our workplace, we are happy to hear them.

Attendance and Punctuality Guidelines:

The Dedicated Resources/ Employees working out of Client offices at various locations are requested to follow the work timings and schedule as per the client office guidelines. Any changes in the client schedule should be communicated to the HR Team.

Work days and Weekly offs will be as per client allocation and deployment (Monday to Friday or Monday to Saturday).

A full work day is considered only when you work for 8 hours starting from your stipulated time, and a half day will be considered only when you work for 5 hours (with lunch break) or 4 hours (excluding the lunch/food break) starting from your stipulated time.

In the event of an absence or tardiness from an assigned work schedule, the employee is required to report the absence to the Company. When reporting absence, the employee must E-mail / Telephone/ SMS/ WhatsApp his or her

supervisor and HR representative only. If any emergency leave then employee must call within two hours of the scheduled start time.

An employee's absence will be deemed unexcused when an employee fails to call in, gives a late notice, fails to give advance notice for an absence that could be anticipated, or exceeds the number of absences as defined by policy or authorized in advance by the Supervisor or HR. Unexcused/uninformed absentees are subject to corrective disciplinary action.

Location Heads/ Supervisors / Leads / Clients (where applicable) in the respective location are requested to be alert and report us of any absence or tardiness of employees in their respective locations.

Following are some points and measures that were taken, and we would like every employee to remember them categorically and take note of them:

☐ **Attendance Entry:-**

- For any biometric registration that is not happening or reflecting, there is a backend file that captures your attendance for the day, irrespective of whether it gets synced with the Online System. The same shall be referred for correction and time reference.
- If still in doubts, accountability and approval from the Supervisor keeping on CC will be taken.
- Anyone having any issues or challenges regarding their bio-metric registrations have to be immediately brought to notice

☐ **Working From Home:**

- Our standard policy is to have employees work from our office premises to ensure collaboration and efficiency. However, we understand that certain situations may arise where working from home becomes necessary, particularly during emergencies.
- If any employee is on "work from home/ outdoor duty," he/she must get approval from the highest reporting authority of the Department in charge and submit it to the HR department for his attendance.
- Absence of any official notification will be deemed "unauthorized absent" and will be adjusted from your balance leaves/salary.



- Work from-home employee should be available online (E-mail, Skype/Mattermost) and accessible /responsive at all times during their 8 hours of duty.
- The decision to allow work from home during emergencies will be at the discretion of **Tecomeng**. Factors considered will include the nature of the emergency, the employee's role, and the feasibility of remote work.
- Employees working from home are expected to maintain the same level of productivity and meet deadlines as if they were in the office.
- Regular communication with supervisors and team members should be maintained through phone calls, emails, or other agreed-upon means

☐ **Working Hours 10 to 7:**

- Between 1:30 to 2:30 PM, 45-minute min Lunch break
- In between Evening, 10 minutes of Tea break.
- In the event that any employee has to move out of the office for any personal reason except during lunch hours, he/she is required to get prior approval from his/her immediate Supervisor and keep HR posted.

Equitable & Safe Workplace:

We are committed to a supportive work environment where all employees have equal opportunity to reach their fullest potential while also protecting and enhancing the human dignity of our people. Therefore, it is our responsibility to create a respectful workplace culture that is free of prejudice, harassment, bias, and discrimination of any kind.

☐ **Equal Employment Opportunity**

Employment for Employee is solely based upon individual merit, qualifications, and professional competence. The company will be an "equal opportunity" organization that prohibits discrimination or harassment based on qualification, race, colour, religion, national origin, sex, age, sexual orientation, language, medical condition, marital status or disability.



☐ **Health & Safety**

Employee will try its best to make sure that the way it conducts its business does not harm the health and safety of its own people or anyone else affected by its activities, products or services. We also trust you not to act in a way that will endanger or adversely affect people on the company premises.

☐ **Sexual Harassment**

Employee prohibits any kind of sexual harassment, be it verbal, physical, or visual. Any complaint pertaining to sexual harassment shall be viewed strictly by the company.

☐ **Environmental Compliance**

The company is committed to protecting and preserving the environment. The company will endeavour to reuse and recycle rather than dispose wherever possible.

☐ **Conclusion**

We expect all employees to be guided by this code of conduct in letter and spirit and to rely on good judgment to uphold a high standard of integrity for ourselves and the company. Also bear in mind that each one of us has a personal responsibility to follow and encourage others to follow and adhere to the principles of the code in our work. In the event of any instance of non-compliance, you are obligated to report it to your seniors or HR. You can either contact your manager, department head, or HR in case you have any questions or concerns.



Company Cyber Security Policy

Policy brief & purpose

Our company's cyber security policy outlines our guidelines and provisions for preserving the security of our data and technology infrastructure.

The more we rely on technology to collect, store, and manage information, the more vulnerable we become to severe security breaches. Human errors, hacker attacks, and system malfunctions could cause great financial damage and may jeopardize our company's reputation.

For this reason, we have implemented a number of security measures. We have also prepared instructions that may help mitigate security risks. We have outlined both provisions in this policy.

Scope

This policy applies to all our employees and anyone who has permanent or temporary access to our systems and hardware.

Policy elements

☐ Confidential data

Confidential data is secret and valuable. Common examples are:

- Unpublished financial information
- Data of customers, partners, or vendors
- Patents, formulas or new technologies
- Customer lists (existing and prospective)

All employees are obliged to protect this data. In this policy, we will give our employees instructions on how to avoid security breaches.



☐ **Protect personal and company devices**

When employees use their digital devices to access company emails or accounts, they introduce security risks to our data. We advise our employees to keep their personal and company tablets and cell phones secure. They can do this if they

- Keep all devices password-protected.
- Choose and upgrade complete antivirus software.
- Ensure they do not leave their devices exposed or unattended.
- Install security updates for browsers and systems monthly or as soon as updates are available.
- Log into company accounts and systems through secure and private networks only.

We also advise our employees to avoid accessing internal systems and accounts from other people's devices or lending their own devices to others.

They should follow instructions to protect their devices and refer to the lead if they have any questions.

☐ **Keep emails safe**

Emails often host scams and malicious software (e.g. worms.) To avoid virus infection or data theft, we instruct employees to:

- Avoid opening attachments and clicking on links when the content is not adequately explained (e.g. "watch this video; it's amazing.")
- Be suspicious of click-bait titles (e.g. offering prizes or advice.)
- Check email and names of people they received a message from to ensure they are legitimate.
- Look for inconsistencies or give-always (e.g. grammar mistakes, capital letters, excessive number of exclamation marks.)

If an employee isn't sure that an email they received is safe, they can refer to your Lead.



☐ **Manage passwords properly**

Password leaks are dangerous since they can compromise our entire infrastructure. Not only should passwords be secure so they won't be easily hacked, but they should also remain secret. For this reason, we advise our employees to:

- Choose passwords with at least eight characters (including capital and lower-case letters, numbers and symbols) and avoid information that can be easily guessed (e.g. birthdays.)
- Remember passwords instead of writing them down. If employees need to write their passwords, they are obliged to keep the paper or digital document confidential and destroy it when their work is done.
- Exchange credentials only when absolutely necessary. When exchanging them in person is not possible, employees should prefer the phone instead of email, and only if they personally recognize the person they are talking to.
- Change their passwords every two months.

Remembering a large number of passwords can be daunting. We will purchase the services of a password management tool that generates and stores passwords. Employees are obliged to create a secure password for the tool itself, following the above-mentioned advice.

☐ **Transfer data securely**

Transferring data introduces security risks. Employees must:

- Avoid transferring sensitive data (e.g., customer information or employee records) to other devices or accounts unless absolutely necessary. When mass transfer of such data is needed, we request employees to ask our lead for help.
- Share confidential data over the company network or system and not over public Wi-Fi or private connection.
- Ensure that the recipients of the data are properly authorized people or organizations and have adequate security policies.

☐ Additional measures

To reduce the likelihood of security breaches, we also instruct our employees to:

- Turn off their screens and lock their devices when leaving their desks.
- Report stolen or damaged equipment as soon as possible to [HR/IT Department].
- Change all account passwords at once when a device is stolen.
- Report a perceived threat or possible security weakness in company systems.
- Refrain from downloading suspicious, unauthorized, or illegal software on their company equipment.
- Avoid accessing suspicious websites.

We also expect our employees to comply with our social media and internet usage policies.

Our company will have all the physical and digital shields to protect information.

☐ Disciplinary Action

We expect all our employees to always follow this policy, and those who cause security breaches may face disciplinary action.

- First-time, unintentional, small-scale security breach: We may issue a verbal warning and train the employee on security.
- Intentional, repeated, or large-scale breaches (which cause severe financial or other damage): We will invoke more severe disciplinary action up to and including termination. We will examine each incident on a case-by-case basis.

Additionally, employees who are observed to disregard our security instructions will face progressive discipline, even if their behaviour hasn't resulted in a security breach.

☐ Take security seriously

Everyone, from our customers and partners to our employees and contractors, should feel that their data is safe. The only way to gain their trust is to proactively protect our systems and databases. We can all contribute to this by being vigilant and keeping cyber security top of mind.

Employee Cell Phone Policy

The cell phone company policy may also be referred to as a **no mobile phones at work policy** or a **bring your own device (BYOD) policy**.

Policy brief & purpose

Our **employee cell phone policy** outlines our guidelines for using cell phones at work.

We recognize that cell phones (and smartphones especially) have become an integral part of everyday life. They may be a great asset if used correctly (for productivity apps, calendars, business calls, etc.)

But cell phones may also cause problems when used imprudently or excessively.

Scope

This policy applies to all of our employees.

Policy elements

Despite their benefits, personal cell phones may cause problems in the workplace. Employees who use their cell phones excessively may:

- Get distracted from their work.
- Disturb colleagues by speaking on their phones.
- Cause security issues from inappropriate use of company-issued equipment or misuse of our company's internet connection.



- They cause accidents when they illegally use their phones inside company vehicles or near areas where using phones is prohibited.

Our company expects employees to use their cell phones prudently during working hours.

We advise our employees to:

- Use company-issued phones for business purposes only and preserve them in perfect condition.
- Surf the internet, text, and talk on the phone only for a few minutes per day.
- Turn off or silence their phones when asked.

We won't allow employees to:

- Play games on the cell phone during working hours.
- Use their cell phone's camera or microphone to record confidential information.
- Use their phones in areas where cell use is explicitly prohibited (e.g. Meeting rooms & Conference rooms).)
- Speak on their phones within earshot of colleagues working spaces during working hours.
- Download or upload inappropriate, illegal, or obscene material on a company cell phone using a corporate internet connection.

How to properly use cell phones in the workplace

Employees can benefit from using cell phones. They're allowed to use their phones:

- To make business calls.
- To use productivity apps.
- To check important messages.
- To make brief personal calls away from the working space of colleagues.

Employees can use their phones during breaks, at lunch hour, and while in a stationary vehicle.



Disciplinary Consequences

Our company retains the right to monitor employees for excessive or inappropriate use of their cell phones. If an employee's phone usage causes a decline in productivity or interferes with our operations, we'll ban that employee from using their cell phones.

Employees may face severe disciplinary action up to and including termination in cases when they:

- Cause a security breach.
- Violate our confidentiality policy.
- Cause an accident by recklessly using their phones.

Employee confidentiality policy

Policy brief & purpose

We designed our **company's confidentiality policy** to explain how we expect our employees to treat confidential information. Employees will unavoidably receive and handle personal and private information about clients, partners and our company. We want to make sure that this information is well-protected.

We must protect this information for two reasons. It may:

- Be legally binding (e.g. sensitive customer data.)
- Constitute the backbone of our business, giving us a competitive advantage (e.g. business processes.)

Scope

This policy affects all employees who may have access to confidential information.



Policy elements

Confidential and proprietary information is secret, valuable, expensive, and/or easily replicated.

Common examples of confidential information are:

- Unpublished financial information
- Data of Customers, Partners, and Vendors
- Patents, formulas or new technologies
- Customer lists (existing and prospective)
- Data entrusted to our company by external parties
- Pricing, marketing and other undisclosed strategies
- Documents and processes explicitly marked as confidential
- Unpublished goals, forecasts and initiatives marked as confidential

Employees may have various levels of authorized access to confidential information

Employee Internet Usage Policy

This Employee Internet Usage Policy also be called Employee Internet Policy, Company Internet Policy or Computer Usage Policy.

Policy brief & purpose

Our employee internet usage policy outlines our guidelines for using our company's internet connection, network, and equipment. We want to avoid inappropriate or illegal internet use that creates risks for our company's legality and reputation.

Scope

This employee internet usage policy applies to all our employees and Interns.

Employee internet usage policy elements



What is appropriate employee internet usage?

Our employees are advised to use our company's internet connection for the following reasons:

- To complete their job duties.
- To seek out information that they can use to improve their work.
- To access their social media accounts while conforming to our social media policy.

We don't want to restrict our employees access to websites of their choice, but we expect our employees to exercise good judgment and remain productive at work while using the internet.

Any use of our network and connection must follow our confidentiality and data protection policy.

Employees should:

- Keep their passwords secret at all times.
- Log into their corporate accounts only on safe devices.
- Use strong passwords to log into work-related websites and services.

What is inappropriate employee internet usage?

Our employees mustn't use our network to:

- Download or upload obscene, offensive, or illegal material.
- Send confidential information to unauthorized recipients.
- Invade another person's privacy and sensitive information.
- Download or upload movies, music, and other copyrighted material and software.
- Visit potentially dangerous websites that can compromise the safety of our network and computers.
- Perform unauthorized or illegal actions, like hacking, fraud, buying/selling illegal goods, and more.
- Also not play Youtube or other through office Internet.



We also advise our employees to be careful when downloading, opening, and opening/executing files and software. If they're unsure if a file is safe, they should ask their supervisor.

Our company may install anti-virus and disk encryption software on its computers.

Employees may not deactivate or configure settings and firewalls without managerial approval.

We won't assume any responsibility if employee devices are infected by malicious software or if their personal data is compromised as a result of inappropriate employee use.

Company-issued equipment

We expect our employees to respect and protect our company's equipment. "Company equipment" in this computer usage policy for employees includes company-issued phones, laptops, tablets, and any other electronic equipment that belongs to our company.

We advise our employees to lock their devices on their desks when they're not using them. Our employees are responsible for their equipment whenever they take it out of the office.

Email

Our employees can use their corporate email accounts for both work-related and personal purposes, as long as they don't violate this policy's rules. Employees shouldn't use their corporate email to:

- Register for illegal, unsafe, disreputable, or suspect websites and services.
- Send obscene, offensive, or discriminatory messages and content.
- Send unauthorized advertisements or solicitation emails.
- Sign up for a competitor's services unless authorized.

Our company has the right to monitor corporate emails. We also have the right to monitor websites employees visit on our computers.



Disciplinary Action

Employees who don't conform to this employee internet usage policy will face disciplinary action. Serious violations will be cause for termination of employment or legal action when appropriate. Examples of serious violations are:

- Using our internet connection to steal or engage in other illegal activities.
- Causing our computers to be infected by viruses, worms or other malicious software.
- Sending offensive or inappropriate emails to our customers, colleagues or partners.

Leave Policy

The objective of the leave policy is to ensure all employees have adequate time away from work while avoiding the accumulation of large amounts of annual leave not taken on the company leave balance sheet.

The leave cycle starts on January 1 and ends on December 31 of every year. An employee will be entitled to paid leave of 1 day for every month and 1 day for every quarter (in advance) you have worked.

Leaves accrued over a year will be carried forward in the next leave cycle. Please note that in a leave cycle, there are 16 leaves that will be allowed and approved for the leave cycle year. Any leaves exceeding 16 will carry forward into next year.

Leave application procedure:

- It is necessary that leave(s) be scheduled in advance and in a manner that balances both the individual's desires and Company's need for appropriate coverage on teams and projects.
- All employees should get e-mail approval or from the ERP system (both) from their Supervisor with HR Team marked on CC for their casual, planned, or sick leaves.



Planned and Unplanned Leave:

- Any leave that has been informed and applied for by e-mail prior to the specified date of leave will be considered as planned leave.
- Example: If an Employee wants to take a leave on May 7-July-2024, the following needs to be done:

> The Employee should have the Supervisor informed for 5 days, i.e., July 1st or 2nd, 2024, about the leave requirement.

> The Employee should drop a letter on or before May 7, 2024. If he fails to do so or applies for leave after July 7, 2024, it will be considered unplanned leave.

- The Respective Supervisor/ Reporting Authority has decision-making power to either approve a requested leave by the employee as Paid or Unpaid based on the business requirements. Supervisor/ Reporting Authority can exercise this right as a response to the email requesting the requested leave.

Leave bifurcation for the year is as follows:

- Earned leave (EL): 16 per year
- These leaves will start accruing from the date of joining; however, they will be available for use only after you are a confirmed employee with the organization.
- There are 2 months of probationary periods. Subject to performance, it can be extended.
- During probation, you are not allowed to take more than 5 leaves, subject to the approval of your reporting authority.
- Any leave taken during the probationary period will be counted as unpaid leave/loss of pay (LOP).
- The list of recognized public holidays will be reviewed and decided by the company at the beginning of each calendar year.
- The final list will be announced to all employees by January 1 each year.
- If an employee joins on or before the 10th of any month, then that particular month will be considered a completed month for probation completion, leave credit, and salary revision on confirmation.



Points to be noted:

- It is not a certainty that all your leave requests will be granted; it is strongly recommended that you obtain approval for leave plans prior to making travel bookings. Out of courtesy to your co-workers, please notify your supervisor immediately of any change in your leave plan.
- In accordance with the above point, the following is expected to be followed with immediate effect:

> Any leave plan that is for more than a day should be intimated at least 10 days in advance to the Supervisor with HR on copy in mail in the format given above. The company will not be responsible for any travel booking cancellations if the leave is unapproved due to work requirements.

> Any leave plan that is of a day should be intimated, at least 48 hours before, to the Supervisor with HR on a copy in mail.

Leave adjustments:-

- Any leave taken in spite of insufficient leave balance will be treated as Loss of Pay (LOP).
- Public and festival holidays would be as per the policy of our company's holiday list. Apart from the ones listed, if anyone wants to take a holiday for any other holiday, they can do so by applying for paid or unpaid leave.
- Any leave taken during the probationary period will be considered LOP. But the earned leave will accrue to the employee's leave balance after the probationary period.
- An employee's request to leave work early may be considered by the Supervisor or Reporting Authority. Approval of such absences should be based on the urgency of the reason for absence and department staffing needs. As a general guide, early leave should not exceed one instance per month and should be communicated in writing to the HR team.

Uninformed or unapproved leave:

- In the event an employee is absent for three days or more without prior notice or approval, such absence is viewed as job abandonment, and a formal absenteeism letter will be sent to his residence.
- In the event of resignation, the leave balance days will not be adjusted against the notice period of the employee.

Sick Leave:

- If any employee requires **more than 2 consecutive days of sick leave**, valid **medical proof** must be submitted. Without proper documentation, the leave will be treated as **unpaid leave**.

Planned Leave:

- For any **planned leave**, employees must inform the management **at least one week in advance**.

Marriage-Related Leave:

- For leave taken for marriage functions, employees are required to submit the **invitation card or related proof** along with the leave request.

Occupational / Workplace Health and Safety policy

Our Occupational and Workplace Health and Safety Policy helps us preserve the best possible work conditions for our employees.

Scope

This Occupational / Workplace Health and Safety Policy apply to all current employees.

Policy elements

There are two aspects to consider when establishing an Occupational / Workplace Health and Safety Program: Preventative Action and Emergency Management.

Preventative action

Preventative action is any action we take to avoid injuries or illness related to workplace conditions.

We'll conduct periodic risk assessments and job hazard analyses to discover what is likely to harm employees. We'll establish preventative measures accordingly.

Potential threats and dangerous situations include, but are not limited to:

- Performing tasks on heights, scaffolds, ladders and other unsteady structures
- Operating dangerous equipment
- Slippery or uneven surfaces
- Electrical infrastructure
- Noise/temperature
- Quality of air

We'll take the following preventative measures:

- When employees work in dangerous contexts or locations, we'll make sure there are safety precautions like safety nets and ropes.
- We'll provide protective gear like gloves, protective uniforms, goggles, etc. Using safety equipment is obligatory.
- Inspectors and quality control employees will inspect equipment and infrastructure regularly
- We'll hold employee training sessions in health & safety standards and procedures.
- Employees who do repairs or cleaning need to put up caution signs
- We'll prohibit smoking indoors

Also, we'll enforce a substance abuse policy to protect employees from colleagues misconduct.

Emergency Management

Emergency management refers to our plan to deal with sudden catastrophes like fire, flood, earthquake, or explosion. These depend on human error or natural forces.

Our emergency management involves the following provisions:

- Technicians (external or internal) are available to repair leakages, damages and blackouts quickly
- Fire extinguishers and other fire protection equipment that are easily accessible
- An evacuation plan posted on the walls of each floor and online
- Fire escapes and safety exits that are clearly indicated and safe
- Fully-stocked first-aid kits at convenient locations

We'll also schedule fire drills and emergency evacuations periodically. We will monitor performance of health and safety procedures and revise them to ensure higher level of protection

Disciplinary Consequences

Every team leader is responsible for implementing this health and safety policy. Employees should follow health and safety instructions and will be held accountable when they don't. We'll take disciplinary action that may extend to termination when employees consistently disregard health and safety rules.

It's everyone's responsibility to contribute to a healthy and safe workplace.

Performance management

It is the key process that brings direct output or productivity for the company.

Steps

1. Set performance objectives for each position
2. Make sure they are SMART: specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound



3. Review meetings every quarter

- a. Check relevance of goals
- b. Evaluate performance as per set standards
- c. If a goal is no longer valid, evaluate performance, give it a score and close it
- d. Add goals with the expected standards

4. Final review in January – December

5. If performance is not up to the set standards consistently, use the performance improvement plan to improve. This can also be used for habitual lateness, poor performance, or attitudinal issues.

Professional Tax

If you ever take a look at your pay stubs, you will notice that there is a small deduction mentioned along with all the HRA, conveyance, and basic salary breakdowns. This deduction is generally to the tune of Rs. 200 or so and is called the professional tax. This tax is generally different for each state, and in certain places, you may notice that there is no deduction under this heading. So the question is, “What is professional tax?”

What is Professional Tax?

Professional tax is a tax that is levied by a state government on all individuals who earn a living through any medium. This should not be confused with the definition of professionals, which indicates people such as doctors. This is a tax that is to be paid by every single earning individual. The calculation and amount collected may differ from one state to another, but it has a limit of Rs. 2500 per year.



Why is it different for different people?

Since it is a tax that is levied by the state government, it tends to differ from one state to another. Each state has a slab that it declares, and the professional tax is deducted based on these slabs. There are some states and union territories that do not charge professional tax either. How it is paid is by dividing the annual professional tax due into 12 equal instalments that are paid every month, except for the one paid in February, which is higher than the other months.

There may also be situations where sources of income falling under different sectors will also be liable for a separate tax. For example, in some states, a person running a business in the transport sector may be required to pay a professional tax of about Rs. 50 per annum for each of the vehicles owned, and it may be subject to a cap of Rs. 1,000 per annum.

Who Collects Professional Tax?

Professional tax is collected by employers from their monthly salaries. It is then paid by them to the government, failing which they can have penalties imposed on them for not collecting or failing to pay the professional tax. If you are not working for anyone, then you are liable to pay the professional tax yourself.

For professionals not working with an employer, they can register for it by applying through a form. Once the form is received, a registration number will be issued to the individual. Payment of the professional tax can be made under these registration numbers at banks. It is also worth noting that, in some states, the government also provides rebates on the taxes if they are paid in a lump sum for a few years together, so it is worth enquiring about the rules of professional tax in your state.

Professional Tax in Gujarat:

Monthly Salary	Amount payable in Gujarat
Upto Rs. 12,000	Nil
Rs.12,000 & above	Rs.200 per month



Exit Process

Objective:

- To ensure a smooth exit for the employee as well as the company.
- To ensure a proper handover from the exiting employee.
- To ensure exiting employees are treated fairly.
- Tap feedback from the exiting employee.

Process:

An Exit policy consists of a statement that states how the organization treats an outgoing employee and how to handle attrition :

- The resigning employee should tender his/her resignation in writing.
- The supervisor of the resigning employee should accept the resignation in writing or by email. Alternatively, if the supervisor is not available, HR can approve this as a special case.
- The immediate supervisor will communicate the last working day of the employee to HR.
- A handover will be planned by the HR informed about it.
- Exit interview by HR.
- Hand over the document from the department head.
- Provident withdrawal forms, if applicable.
- Return company property like laptop, data cards, mobile handsets, etc.
- Return the access card.
- Deletion of email IDs, other ids like JIRA, etc.
- Removing access.
- The exit checklist is to be completed by the employee (no dues or objections).
- HR will provide the relieving letter and the experience letter.
- Once the exit formalities are completed, HR will process the final settlement check for the exiting employee. The final settlement will be processed in next month's salary cycle.
- However, if an employee is being terminated, some of the above practices will not be followed.
- This will be based on the discretion of the organization and the policies they want to adopt.



Salary During Notice Period:

- If an employee is serving their notice period, their salary for the two-month notice period will be held. The withheld salary will be paid on the 7th of the following month after completing the notice period.
- This ensures clarity for employees regarding their salary disbursement during the notice period.

Outside Employment (Freelancing and Second Jobs)**Policy Statement:**

Tecoreng requires all full-time employees to dedicate their professional time, attention, and loyalty exclusively to the company. Employees are hired on the basis that their full capabilities and professional time will be applied to the performance of their duties at Tecoreng.

Restriction:

Employees are strictly restricted from engaging in any form of outside employment, including freelancing, consulting, self-employment, or holding a second job, whether compensated or uncompensated, while actively employed by Tecoreng. This restriction is necessary to prevent conflicts of interest, protect the company's proprietary information, and ensure an employee's focus and capacity are not diverted from their primary responsibilities.

Violation and Disciplinary Action:

Any violation of this policy is considered a grave breach of the employment contract and company trust.

If the company becomes aware that an employee is engaging in freelancing or a second job, they will be subject to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination of employment (firing) without notice or severance.



DECLARATION

I have read, understood, and acknowledged receipt of the HR policy. I will comply with the guidelines set out in this policy and understand that failure to do so might result in disciplinary or legal action.

Signature:

Date:

Name:

Department:
